

Turn Trump regret into a November no-show

Funder brief: answers to the four questions your advisers asked. Whit Pendergast, Hoplight. September 24, 2026.

1 • BUDGET

\$35K answers the question.
\$180K proves it in one state.
\$475K makes it replicate.

Every dollar of ads runs only after a randomized test picks the message.

2 • PARTNERS

One role is open: a neutral or right-of-center vehicle. Every other seat is filled.

Test vendor, measurement, creative and operations are named below.

3 • MESSAGES

Four messages and a placebo: two Epstein frames, two Iran war frames.

Eight creative concepts below, with the frame each one tests.

4 • EVIDENCE

A randomized trial of 3,006 adults and 6.5 million views of Epstein ads on Meta.

Plus what changed since the July 2025 memo.

THE STRATEGY

His coalition rests on us versus them. The Epstein files and the Iran war are proof he is them.

The glue of the Trump coalition is one claim: he is on the side of regular people. This program does not argue policy and never sounds like the left. It shows soft 2024 Trump voters, inside their own values and in a voice they trust, that the swamp kept its secrets and the wars came anyway. The aim is dissonance, then an exit ramp with dignity: a regretful voter who stays home on November 3 rather than one who is asked to switch.

How the ads work. Static and short motion ads on Meta, from a neutral or right-of-center name, to about 800,000 soft Trump voters per state. Creative implies rather than asserts, which is what Meta's review has let through for ten months. Each week the losing variants are cut and the money moves to the winners. Nothing names a 2026 candidate, so the program stays inside a C4 and files nothing with the FEC.

1 BUDGET: WHAT EACH LEVEL OF INVESTMENT BUYS

An answer

Which betrayal and which frame move soft Trump voters, from a randomized survey test among 2024 Trump voters, in ten to fourteen days. A tested message set and a go or no-go before any ad money moves.

\$35K · no vehicle needed

Proof in one state

The winning messages run four weeks to about 800,000 soft Trump voters in one Senate state or a set of House districts, with a held-out control. A measured effect on enthusiasm and turnout, and a playbook that works again.

\$180K · \$95K of it in ads

A result that replicates

The same run in four states or district sets, about 3 million people, each with its own holdout. A finding that holds across places instead of resting on one, and messages and audiences carried into 2028.

\$475K · \$340K of it in ads

WHERE THE MONEY GOES

	ANSWER	ONE STATE	FOUR STATES
Ads on Meta	0	\$95K	\$340K
Randomized message test, 2024 Trump voters, regret oversample	\$24K	\$24K	\$24K
In -field measurement, designed with your advisers	0	\$25K	\$50K
Creative, at cost	\$3K	\$9K	\$16K
Hoplight: messages, copy, ad operations, results memo	\$8K	\$27K	\$45K
Total	\$35K	\$180K	\$475K

These totals assume an existing C4 takes the program on. If a vehicle has to be formed, add \$25K to \$75K for counsel, compliance and setup, and ten to twenty days before the first ad. A third issue, rising costs, adds two test arms for \$6K to \$12K. Ad prices are the political-category rates this account already pays on Meta, \$11 to \$15 per thousand views.

ROLE	WHO	STATUS
The vehicle	An existing 501(c)(4) with a neutral or right-of-center brand, Meta's political ad approval already in hand, and an ad account with spending history. Its counsel clears each ad. I tried standing up a right-coded Meta organization myself in 2025; in the interest of time an outside group should own the equivalent. Hoplight runs the campaign and does not own the vehicle.	OPEN 3 to 7 days to first ad once named
Randomized message test	Grow Progress, the vendor that fielded the August 2025 trial. Custom screener admits only 2024 Trump voters, with an oversample of those who express regret. Results in ten to fourteen days.	PRICED books on a yes
In-field measurement	Designed with your experiment advisers. Held-out areas with a short post-survey fielded by Grow Progress, or person-level randomization if the vehicle already texts its list. Voter-file match through the vehicle's data vendor.	PROPOSED advisers shape it
Messages, copy, ad operations, results memo	Hoplight. Messages are written inside the audience's own values by the tool that beat the staff-written message in the 2025 trial, then edited by hand and tested before any ad runs.	COMMITTED
Creative production	The team behind the 6.5 million views of Epstein creative on Meta, producing static, six to fifteen second motion, and image texts at cost.	COMMITTED
Values-based targeting overlay	Optional. The Democracy Audiences Map from DCC and Harmony Labs, built on media-consumption data, to sharpen which soft Trump voters see which frame. Conversation held in May 2026.	OPTIONAL no commitment yet
Compliance counsel	The vehicle's own political law counsel reviews every ad before it loads. Ads that name only Trump and the issues carry no FEC filing; naming a 2026 candidate would move the work to a PAC.	OPEN carried by the vehicle

The one thing to source. If your network has a C4 that fits the first row, the program can be live within a week of funding. If not, the message test still starts on a yes, and the ten to fourteen days it takes are the window to find or form the vehicle.

3 MESSAGES AND CREATIVE TO TEST

THE TEST	WHAT IT MEASURES	THE TWO FRAMES
Five arms. Epstein in two frames, the Iran war in two frames, and a placebo. Randomized survey among 2024 Trump voters only, with an oversample of those who express regret. Rising costs can add two arms.	Four outcomes. Enthusiasm to vote, Trump approval, regret, and favorability toward the Republican Senate candidate. The winning arm and frame go to ads; the rest stop there.	Promise broken: he said one thing to you and did another. Elite protection: the club looks after its own and you pay. Each issue gets one of each.
EPSTEIN • ELITE PROTECTION The files are real. The names are still blacked out. A redacted page, black bars peeling back. One bar half-lifted with nothing readable beneath. Emotion: suspicion, recognition	EPSTEIN • PROMISE BROKEN He said drain the swamp. Then he sealed it. Black and white still of a 2016 rally sign, cut to a court seal stamped over a redaction. Emotion: betrayal	EPSTEIN • ELITE PROTECTION Clinton. Trump. Gates. Same flight log. You think they are fighting each other? A blurred luxury party behind three names in plain type. Emotion: class fury, us versus them inverted EPSTEIN • SHARE PROMPT Patriots don't stay quiet. Ask who they are protecting. Handwritten names on a petition beside empty lines. The retargeting and volunteer-share variant. Emotion: pride, belonging
IRAN WAR • PROMISE BROKEN He promised no new wars. Then he started one. Freeze frame of the 2024 promise, cut to a carrier deck at night. Six seconds. Emotion: betrayal, recognition	IRAN WAR • ELITE PROTECTION Your son's war. Their contracts. A recruiting office storefront beside a defense-stock ticker climbing. Emotion: class fury	RISING COSTS • PROMISE BROKEN • OPTIONAL He said prices would drop on day one. A grocery receipt, the date circled. Static. Emotion: betrayal RISING COSTS • ELITE PROTECTION • OPTIONAL Tariffs for you. Tax cuts for them. Split frame: a checkout line and a private terminal. Emotion: class fury

Rules every piece follows. Imply, never assert, which is what ten months of Meta review has let through. No 2026 candidate named and no instruction about voting, which keeps the work inside a C4. No AI-generated or altered images of real people. Copy is written inside the audience's own values and edited by hand before the test, and only tested winners reach the feed.

Talk to them inside their own values, in a voice they trust.

81 from 56

Republican agreement on a pay message with a frame from Hoplight's message tool, in a randomized trial of 3,006 US adults in August 2025. The staff-written message reached 70. With enterprising conservatives on union support, 55 to 71 where the staff message fell to 51.

Creative that Meta already runs, and people already stop for.

6.5M views

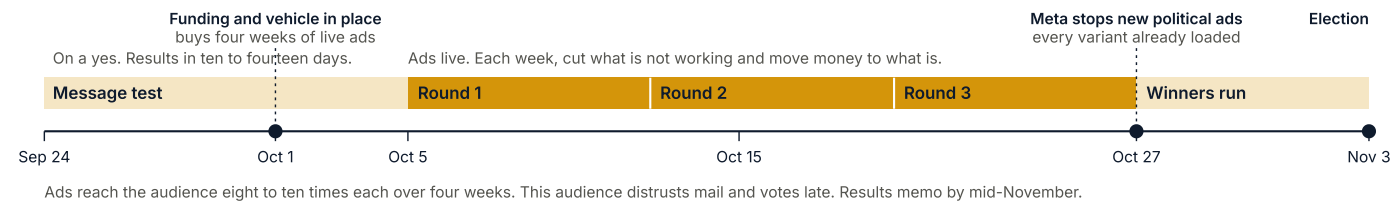
Ten months of Epstein-themed creative inside more than \$1 million of Meta ads for a commercial activist brand Whit co-founded. Review let it through when it implied, people stopped for it like anything else on the account, and clicks cost 18 percent less.

A large audience almost nobody is talking to.

1 in 5 regret their vote

Navigator Research, September 2026: one in five 2024 Trump voters regret it, and the Iran war and rising costs top their reasons. Roughly 15 million people nationally. Progressive-branded messages lose this audience; a right-of-center voice is the only one it will hear.

TIMELINE TO NOVEMBER 3



WHAT CHANGED SINCE THE JULY 2025 MEMO

The 2025 plan spent its first \$85K on petition ads to build a list, then retargeted the list. The 2026 plan spends the first dollars on a **randomized test and a measured turnout effect**, because the election is forty days out and a list has no time to mature. The Iran war joins Epstein as a second proven betrayal. The petition and lead capture can ride along at no extra cost if the vehicle wants the list for 2028.

CHOICES FOR YOUR ADVISERS

- Where.** One Senate state, or a set of close House districts.
- Measurement.** Held-out areas with a short survey, or person-level randomization if the vehicle already texts.
- Vehicle type.** A C4 while ads name only Trump and the issues. Naming a 2026 candidate moves it to a PAC.
- A third issue.** Rising costs adds two test arms, about \$6K to \$12K.
- Added channels.** Volunteer sharing and image texts ride on the same creative.